



SWMS16

Safe Work Method Statement

Work in an area with movement of powered mobile plant

Document number	EC-SWMS16	Revision	1.0
Prepared by	Ecology Consulting — WHS / Field team	Document release date	
Approved by	Tony Webster — Managing Director / WHS Officer	Next review	

Note: Work must be performed in accordance with this Safe Work Method Statement (SWMS). This SWMS must be kept and available for inspection until the work is completed. If revised, every version must be kept. If a notifiable incident occurs in relation to the work in this SWMS, the SWMS must be kept for at least two years from the date of the notifiable incident. This SWMS is accessed and acknowledged through the Ecology Consulting digital WHS platform; field forms are submitted from site and reviewed centrally by the administration team.

Scope & limitations: Works are limited to ecological survey, observation and clearing supervision. **Ecology Consulting personnel will not operate mobile plant and will not direct construction activities unless authorised.** Personnel will not undertake excavation or ground disturbance. Where plant and personnel cannot be adequately separated, work does not proceed.

Project & PCBU details

Person conducting a business or undertaking (PCBU)	Ecology Consulting Pty Ltd · ABN 68 647 633 163	Contact number	0472 569 988 (office / Check-in)
EC offices	34 Atchison St, Wollongong NSW 2500 · 42 Goulburn St, Crookwell NSW 2583 · 473 Townsend St, Albury NSW 2640		
Client / Principal Contractor			
Work activity	Ecological survey, pre-clearing survey, clearing supervision and fauna rescue in areas where powered mobile plant is operating.		
Workplace location			
Field work duration			

Legislation, codes of practice & standards

Acts & Regulations	Work Health and Safety Act 2011 (NSW) and the Work Health and Safety Regulation (NSW); Work Health and Safety Act 2011 (Cth) and WHS Regulations 2011 (Cth) where work is on Commonwealth land or for a Commonwealth entity (Comcare jurisdiction); Work Health and Safety Act 2011 (ACT) and WHS Regulation 2011 (ACT) for works in the ACT.
Codes of Practice	Safe Work Australia model Codes as adopted in NSW and the ACT: <i>How to manage work health and safety risks; Work health and safety consultation, cooperation and coordination; Construction work; First aid in the workplace; Managing the work environment and facilities; Preparation of safe work method statements for construction work. Managing risks of plant in the workplace; Traffic management in workplaces; Excavation work.</i>
Standards & guidance	AS/NZS 4602 High visibility safety garments; AS/NZS 1801 Occupational protective helmets; AS/NZS 2210 Occupational protective footwear; AS 1319 Safety signs. Before You Dig Australia (BYDA) service location.
EC WHS documentation	EC Work Health and Safety Management System and WHS Handbook; EC Risk Management Processes (EC-RMP-FRM-001); EC Hazard Register and Trigger Action Response List (TARL); Pre-Mobilisation Checklist; Pre-Travel Vehicle Safety Checklist; Journey Management Plan; Daily Toolbox Talk; site-specific Emergency Response Plan (ERP); JSA — General Field Surveys; JSA — Remote and Isolated Work; SOP — Journey Management; SOP — Terrestrial Fauna; SOP — Fieldwork Biosecurity. SWMS15 — Work on, in or adjacent to a traffic corridor; SWMS12 — Work on or near energised electrical installations or services; SOP — Clearing Supervision; JSA — Preclearing; JSA — Clearing Supervision.

Mandatory personal protective equipment & field equipment

Confirmed present and serviceable on the Pre-Mobilisation Checklist and verified by the Field Lead at the Daily Toolbox Talk. Faulty items are tagged out and removed from service.

Hard Hat	Safety Glasses	Gloves	Hearing Protection	Hi-Vis Clothing	Sun Safe PPE	Wide Brim Hat	Capped Boots
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Fire Extinguisher	Remote First Aid Kit	Snake Bite Kit	In Reach / Sat Phone	Two-Way Radio	Torch / Headlamp	GPS	Drinking Water
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Two-Way Radio (plant channel)	Spotter Vest	BYDA Plans	Exclusion Zone Delineation	Site Induction Card	White Card	Reflective Hi-Vis (low light)	Dust Mask
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Hierarchy of controls

Eliminate	Avoid working in areas with operating mobile plant wherever practicable — undertake surveys outside plant work zones, use remote observation tools, or delay works until plant activity has ceased.
------------------	---

Substitute	Use safer work methods that reduce exposure — schedule surveys when plant is not operating, use designated safe observation areas, or alter work sequencing to avoid simultaneous plant and personnel interaction.
Isolate	Establish and maintain exclusion zones and physical separation between personnel and operating plant using barriers, spotters, delineated work zones and controlled access points; restrict entry into plant operating areas at all times.
Engineer	Use engineered controls implemented by the Principal Contractor such as plant with reversing alarms, flashing lights, proximity detection systems, physical barriers, defined haul routes and designated pedestrian pathways.
Administrative	SWMS, site-specific risk assessments, inductions, communication protocols, supervision, traffic and plant management plans, and defined roles such as spotters; ensure clear line-of-sight rules, plant–person interaction procedures, and strict stop-work triggers.
PPE	Last line of defence only — high visibility clothing, safety boots, helmets, eye protection and hearing protection where required. PPE must not be relied upon as the primary control for mobile plant risks.

Hazards & controls

Complete daily before entering any area where plant is operating.

What are the hazards & risks	What are the control measures	Select relevant controls (completed onsite by Field Lead)
Planning, preparation and travelling to site		
Inadequate planning leading to uncontrolled risk; unfit or untrained personnel	Attend the pre-field meeting with the Project Lead and Project Manager to review scope, methodology and expected hazards; confirm site access, keys, codes, inductions and property constraints; and confirm all staff are trained, competent and fit for work. Medical concerns are disclosed privately to the Field Lead. Review this SWMS, the relevant JSA and SOP, the Field Plan and the site-specific ERP. Verify training currency — workers are not mobilised with expired mandatory training.	☐ Pre-field meeting ☐ SWMS / JSA / SOP reviewed ☐ ERP reviewed ☐ Training verified ☐ Medical disclosures
Vehicle failure, missing safety equipment or fatigue during travel	Complete the Pre-Travel Vehicle Safety Checklist — first aid kit, extinguisher, spare tyre, torch, water and PPE present; vehicle free from leaks, faults or damage; electrical issues visually inspected only and tagged out if unsafe. Complete the Journey Management Plan. Minimum 10-hour rest between shifts before driving; personal fatigue self-assessment before departure; rest breaks every two hours; carry water, snacks and electrolytes; second driver for long or remote trips where practicable. Zero blood alcohol concentration applies to all work driving.	☐ Vehicle checklist done ☐ JMP completed ☐ 10-hr rest confirmed ☐ Fatigue self-assessment
Travelling into fire, flood, storm, smoke or hazardous road conditions	Complete the Pre-Travel Environmental and Hazard Check using BOM weather warnings, Hazards Near Me, RFS fire danger ratings, Air Quality Index, lightning trackers, Live Traffic NSW and telecommunications coverage maps. Do not travel where there are emergency warning fire events, hazardous air quality, active storm warnings or flooded roads. Never drive through floodwater under any circumstance. If conditions change, stop, reassess and notify the Communication Officer.	☐ BOM / Hazards Near Me ☐ RFS rating checked ☐ AQI checked ☐ Live Traffic NSW ☐ Coverage checked
Hazards not identified, assessed or communicated before work commences	All team members participate in a pre-commencement Daily Toolbox Talk led on site by the Field Lead and documented on the EC WHS form — site-specific hazards identified; collaborative risk assessment using the EC risk matrix (rating one to six) with agreed controls and a revised residual rating; PPE and equipment readiness confirmed; ERP reviewed and Emergency Meeting Point identified; communication and check-in requirements confirmed; health or access needs disclosed privately; and worker sign-on confirming understanding and fitness for work. Hazards already in the EC Hazard Register are managed under the TARL. No worker commences without sign-on.	☐ Toolbox talk held ☐ Risk assessment rated ☐ Emergency Meeting Point ☐ All workers signed on
Loss of contact with the field team; delayed emergency response	Mandatory check-ins with the Communication Officer (0472 569 988) before departing base, on arrival at site or accommodation, before leaving site, and on return to base. Every check-in must be acknowledged. A missed or unacknowledged check-in triggers escalation through the Communication Officer, Project Lead or Project Manager, and the WHS Officer, and is grounds for activating the ERP. Carry redundant communications — mobile phone, UHF radio and In Reach or satellite communicator, with a PLB where remoteness warrants. Roles are assigned at the toolbox talk: Field Lead, Communication Officer and workers.	☐ Check-in schedule agreed ☐ Comms tested ☐ Roles assigned ☐ Escalation briefed
Pre-planning and services		

What are the hazards & risks	What are the control measures	Select relevant controls (completed onsite by Field Lead)
Inadequate planning leading to collision with plant or vehicles; uncontrolled interaction between personnel and mobile plant	Complete the daily SWMS, JSA and toolbox talk prior to commencing work. Identify all mobile plant activities and establish work zones. Confirm all required permits and approvals are in place. Implement the relevant SWMS for traffic (SWMS15) and electrical hazards (SWMS12) where applicable. Ensure all personnel understand plant exclusion zones and movement areas. Work must not commence until risks are identified and controls implemented.	☐ Pre-start completed ☐ Plant activities identified ☐ SWMS15 / SWMS12 applied ☐ Exclusion zones understood
Contact with underground services — electricity, gas, communications; serious injury, explosion or service disruption	Obtain current Before You Dig (BYDA) plans prior to works. Physically verify service locations onsite where possible using markers, pits and visual indicators. Treat all unidentified services as live. Ecology Consulting staff must not undertake excavation. If services are at risk, work must stop and the Principal Contractor notified.	☐ BYDA reviewed ☐ Services verified onsite ☐ No excavation by EC
Arrival, parking and public interface		
Vehicle rollover or instability; bogging in soft ground or near edges; interaction with plant during arrival	Park in designated safe areas away from mobile plant, traffic routes, and soft edges, embankments and excavations. Maintain clear access and egress routes. Do not park within plant operating zones. Notify the site supervisor of vehicle location on arrival.	☐ Safe parking established ☐ Access / egress clear ☐ Location notified
Interaction with live traffic or the public; plant entering a traffic corridor; reduced visibility and uncontrolled access	Implement SWMS15 (traffic management) where applicable. A Traffic Management Plan and Traffic Guidance Scheme must be in place. Maintain separation between plant, pedestrians and traffic. Do not enter live traffic areas unless controlled. Stop work if traffic controls are inadequate.	☐ TMP implemented ☐ Separation maintained ☐ Controls adequate
Working in an area with mobile plant		
Being struck by moving plant or vehicles; crushing or entrapment between plant and objects; blind spots and limited operator visibility	Maintain exclusion zones around all operating plant. Plant operating zones must be defined, communicated and marked where practicable. Never approach plant unless the operator has acknowledged your presence and the plant is stationary where required. Maintain clear line of sight with operators at all times and remain outside plant blind spots. Use designated pedestrian pathways where available. Remain alert to plant movement and alarms. Personnel must never walk behind operating plant. No person is to approach mobile plant until positive communication has been established with the operator.	☐ Exclusion zones maintained ☐ Operator acknowledgement ☐ Line of sight kept ☐ Never behind plant
Crushing or collision during loading and unloading; poor communication between operator and spotter	Use a competent spotter when loading or unloading where required. The spotter must stand in a safe, visible position and maintain constant communication with the operator, and must never stand behind or within the travel path of plant. The operator must maintain visual contact with the spotter at all times and stop operation immediately if visual contact is lost.	☐ Spotter assigned ☐ Safe spotter position ☐ Visual contact maintained
Equipment failure leading to incident; loss of control of plant or vehicle	Complete daily vehicle and plant inspections prior to use. Report defects immediately. Tag faulty plant and equipment out of service. Do not use defective or unsafe equipment.	☐ Inspections completed ☐ Defects reported ☐ Faulty plant tagged out
Incompetent or unsafe plant operation; unauthorised use of plant	Ecology Consulting personnel must not operate mobile plant. Only trained, licensed and authorised operators are to use plant. Report unsafe or non-compliant behaviour to the Site Supervisor immediately and withdraw to a safe location until resolved.	☐ Operators verified ☐ No operation by EC ☐ Issues reported
Clearing supervision and fauna rescue near plant		

What are the hazards & risks	What are the control measures	Select relevant controls (completed onsite by Field Lead)
Plant restart or movement during fauna rescue; bites, scratches and envenomation	Ecology Consulting staff are observers only and do not direct plant unless authorised. Ensure all plant is stopped and isolated before any fauna rescue commences and confirm with the operator directly. Only trained and authorised personnel handle fauna. Ground-based rescue only — no climbing or elevated work. Confirm all-clear before works resume.	☐ Plant stopped & isolated ☐ Rescue authorised ☐ Ground-based only ☐ All-clear confirmed
Falling limbs or debris during clearing; reduced visibility from dust	Maintain the arborist or feller exclusion zone at all times — at least one tree length from the tree being felled. Observe from a position outside the drop zone with a clear escape path. Cease observation during high winds or when visibility is reduced by dust, smoke or rain.	☐ Drop zone maintained ☐ Escape path clear ☐ Ceased in wind / dust

Stop-work triggers — stop work immediately, move to a safe location, notify the Field Lead and Principal Contractor, and do not recommence until the risk is controlled and communicated

Loss of separation between personnel and plant	Plant operating outside designated zones	Poor visibility from dust, weather or lighting	Loss of communication with operators or spotters
Unsafe or unlicensed plant operation identified	Unknown hazards or services identified	Exclusion zone breached	Any situation where a worker feels unsafe

Emergency response

Read with the site-specific Emergency Response Plan. The Field Lead is the Chief Warden. Any worker may activate the ERP.

1 · Activate & make safe	Stop work and ensure the area is safe for responders. Do not move an injured person unless there is immediate danger. Where a person is struck by or trapped beneath plant, do not attempt to move the plant unless directed by the operator and it is safe — uncontrolled movement can worsen crush injury. Ensure all plant in the vicinity is stopped and isolated before responders approach. The Field Lead assesses the situation, initiates the response, directs evacuation to the Emergency Meeting Point, accounts for all personnel using the Daily Toolbox Talk sign-on sheet, and coordinates communication with the office.
2 · Call for help	Call 000 or 112, or activate the In Reach or PLB where there is no coverage. Provide GPS coordinates and the nearest cross roads, the nature of the emergency and safe access routes. Assign one person to guide responders in.
3 · First aid	A trained first aider assesses the casualty, but only where it is safe to do so. Control bleeding, immobilise suspected fractures and monitor breathing. If unconscious but breathing, place in the recovery position; if not breathing, commence CPR. Record all treatment on the First Aid Treatment Log.
4 · Post-incident	Report to the WHS Officer and complete an Incident Report Form within the required timeframe, submitted through the digital WHS platform. The WHS Officer updates the Incident Register and notifies the regulator of any notifiable incident. Attend debrief; review and update this SWMS and the ERP; restock emergency equipment used. Psychosocial support is provided where workers were exposed to distressing events.

Emergency services	000 or 112	State Emergency Service (SES)	13 25 00
EC office / Check-in Officer	0472 569 988	Managing Director / WHS Officer	Tony Webster · 0448 439 334
Poisons Information Hotline	13 11 26	Wildlife rescue	1300 094 737
Employee Assistance Program	1300 172 327 — free and confidential	Nearest hospital & muster point	Identified per site in the ERP; confirmed at the toolbox talk

Training & competency requirements

Required for this activity	White Card (General Construction Induction) is mandatory. Spotter Certification is required where a worker acts as a spotter. Site-specific plant and traffic inductions must be completed before entering any plant operating area. Fauna Handling Training and snake handling awareness are required for fauna rescue activities.
Baseline — all field personnel	White Card (General Construction Induction); current driver's licence of appropriate class; CPR certification (annual renewal); Provide First Aid (HLTAID011), and Remote First Aid (HLTAID013) for remote or isolated work; General Fauna Handling Training.
Verification	All training must be current, recorded and verifiable prior to mobilisation. Records are maintained by the Administration Officer and retained for a minimum of five years, with expiry notifications issued in advance; workers are not mobilised with expired mandatory training. Competency is verified annually and observed on site by Principal or Senior Ecologists, Project Managers and the WHS Officer. Subcontractor training evidence is collected and retained for audit.

Daily SWMS acknowledgement & sign-on register

All personnel must read, understand and sign this SWMS before commencing work, confirming they are fit for duty, competent and able to perform assigned tasks safely. Completed with the Daily Toolbox Talk and submitted through the digital WHS platform.

#	Name	Role	Signature	Date
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				

© Ecology Consulting Pty Ltd 2026 · Reviewed and approved by the WHS Officer. Review annually or following any incident, near miss, audit finding or change to legislation, work practice or site conditions.